Barran Dodger SOS — Reordered Paragraphs

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ituation

institutional abandonment.

OHCHR receipt number: UR/UST/23/AUS/17

I demand immediate intervention, independent investigation, protection, and the restoration of my freedom, dignity, safety and human rights.

I am not suicidal. I want to live. I am demanding the conditions necessary to live.

My address is 55B Archbold Road, Long Jetty. If I had someone to help me, I would not be asking strangers on a public website. Everyone who is supposed to help already knows where I am.

I am demanding to be released from the circumstances in which I am currently living: circumstances that I describe as entrapment, institutional neglect, impoverishment, exploitation and deliberate containment. I believe these conditions have become a mechanism for silencing, isolating and gagging an unprotected whistleblower.

I do not need a hospital, or a mental-health team, as a

substitute for justice. I say the distress, the poverty and what I call the torture are being created by the corruption I am trying to expose, and then used against me. I say that when I show an ordinary human response to those conditions, I am taken from my therapy dog and medicated, as if a drug were the answer to what is brutally unjust in my life. I say the hospital and the health departments have been ineffective, medically incompetent and ethically compromised, and that they have functioned as part of the same failure. I do not consent to being locked up again. I say it has already happened, and that it has not helped. Another admission is not an investigation, and it is not my release.

My circumstances raise serious questions about Australia's compliance with its obligations under the NDIS legislation, particularly the principles of choice and control, dignity, independence and safeguarding, as well as its international human-rights obligations under treaties it has ratified.

I am not asking for another bureaucratic referral, another assessment, another complaint acknowledgement or another professional to pass responsibility to somebody else. I am demanding that the conditions themselves change. I want to be free. I want to live independently, safely and with dignity.

This is no longer just my fight. This is a public reckoning.

A message of gratitude to every member of the public who

has acknowledged this SOS, looked at the evidence, and stood alongside me.

Thank you. For a long time I have been trying to draw attention to circumstances that I believe should never have been permitted in a democratic society. To see members of the public recognise the seriousness of what I have been saying, question the conduct of people in authority, and ask for accountability is more than personal support. This is now far beyond my story.

Thank you to everyone who has refused to look away. Thank you for recognising that a vulnerable person's suffering should not become entertainment, an administrative inconvenience, or an opportunity for financial exploitation. Thank you for understanding that human rights cannot depend on whether someone is popular, connected, financially secure, or able to present himself as flawless.

I am not performing a character. I am not maintaining a manufactured public image. I am not pretending to be perfect, and I am not claiming to be a person who has never made a mistake. I am simply existing. I am a human being who has experienced extraordinary circumstances, who has spoken about them, and who continues to ask for recognition, accountability, protection and a dignified response. I do not need to manufacture a scandal. I do not need to invent a character. The documentary record, the unanswered questions, the institutional correspondence and the circumstances in this SOS have to be examined on their merits.

The professionals and institutions entrusted with care, protection, investigation and accountability have, in my experience, repeatedly failed to provide even a basic acknowledgement, let alone a meaningful and dignified response. Why should a vulnerable person have to fight this hard simply to be acknowledged? Why should someone raising safeguarding concerns meet silence, deflection and a reluctance to examine the evidence? Why should the person asking the questions become the subject of scrutiny while the questions remain unanswered? Why should anyone entrusted with public authority, professional responsibility or the care of another human being believe they can avoid accountability by refusing to respond? These are no longer questions that concern me alone.

This is about the value of human life

A society cannot claim to uphold human rights, democracy, justice or human dignity while a vulnerable person is left in circumstances in which his life, safety and psychological wellbeing are seriously endangered, without effective intervention or independent scrutiny.

I have repeatedly described circumstances that I believe involved prolonged abuse, neglect, exploitation, coercion and institutional abandonment. I have raised concerns about the conduct of people and organisations paid to provide care, and about whether financial and institutional interests were allowed to take precedence over my welfare. I have also raised profoundly serious concerns about a life-threatening medical

event, my revival and a subsequent brain injury, and whether the circumstances of that event, and the responsibilities of those involved, have ever received the independent investigation they warrant. These matters must not be dismissed or resolved through institutional self-protection. They require independent examination of the medical records, the decisions, the evidence and the responsibilities of everyone involved.

I have described circumstances in which I felt increasingly unsafe, abandoned and deprived of the support that was supposed to protect me. I have repeatedly questioned whether the conditions in which I was required to live, the failure of assistance, and the conduct of those entrusted with my care created an environment in which suicide became an increasingly foreseeable risk. I cannot establish another person's intentions simply by describing the consequences of their conduct. That is why an independent investigation is necessary. I will not accept that the possibility of a vulnerable person's death can be treated as an acceptable outcome of institutional failure. Nor will I accept a situation in which a person dies, the circumstances are inadequately examined, and responsibility is then placed on the person whose vulnerability should have prompted protection. A person's death must never become an institutional escape from accountability. If someone entrusted with another human being's care contributes, through misconduct, neglect or deliberate wrongdoing, to circumstances that place that person's life at risk, those questions must be independently investigated. It is not enough to say that procedures were followed. Human life is more important than institutional

reputation.

I am not suicidal. I want to live. I am asking for the conditions necessary to live, and for the records to be examined while I am here to answer questions.

The public has every right to demand answers

This is not simply a disagreement between an individual and a department, a provider or a professional body. It raises questions about what happens when the person making the complaint depends on the organisation being complained about, when the people asked to investigate are connected to the structures being questioned, and when accommodation, income, safety, healthcare and legal assistance are compromised while the complaints remain unresolved.

I am not asking anyone to accept every allegation without examination. I am asking that the evidence be examined without prejudice, that the people involved be given the chance to answer, and that the scrutiny be independent rather than an institution investigating itself. I am asking that my humanity not be made conditional on my silence, my agreeableness or my convenience.

I do not want revenge. I want accountability. I want the circumstances investigated. I want the truth established. I want other vulnerable people protected from what I have described. This is no longer only about Barran Dodger. It is about what kind of humanity we are prepared to defend. A society that cannot protect its most vulnerable members has a

fundamental problem. A society that silences people who raise concerns has a fundamental problem. A society that allows institutional reputation to matter more than human life has a problem that cannot be resolved by public relations.

The public deserves answers. The evidence deserves examination. Human life deserves protection. Accountability must not be optional. I will continue to stand by the documentary record and ask for an independent investigation. I will continue to speak. I will continue to exist. I will not apologise for being a human being whose existence has brought uncomfortable questions into public view.

The record remains. The public is watching. The questions must be answered.

With profound gratitude, Dr Richard William McLean, Barran Resonance Dodger. Praise Jesus.